

THE PLAYER-COACH PLAYBOOK

Lesson 5

Play the Season, Sustainable Performance

About 55 minutes of reps this week. Your core rep, Drill 5.2, your energy audit, takes about 15.

M.V.P. Accelerator™

POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™

LESSON 5 · GOES WITH VIDEO 5.1

Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 5

Welcome to Lesson 5. We are deep into the season, where cumulative fatigue can derail even the best plans. This lesson is about the science of sustainable high performance.

The best Athleaders and coaches know that victory depends on managing Wellbeing and energy, not just time. Your role is to model these sustainable practices to ensure you and your team can finish the season strong and avoid burnout.

"Rest isn't a bug; it's a feature of high performance. It's the strategic pause that fuels the next sprint."

This week's A.R.A.W. focus:

Wellbeing | Alignment

Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- Conduct a personal "Energy Audit" to identify and manage your key energy drains and sources.
- Learn to consciously model sustainable work practices to influence your team's culture.
- Develop a proactive plan for facilitating team recovery after intense periods of effort.



The Science of Performance

Management writer Sylvia Ann Hewlett found that 35% of high earners worked more than 60 hours a week, and 10% more than 80. A Stanford study found that working longer hours doesn't make people more productive. This lesson provides the tactical plays to counter this trend.

Sources: Sylvia Ann Hewlett, as cited by Morten Hansen (mortenhansen.com); CNBC (March 2019) on John Pencavel's research at Stanford.

START HERE

Drill 5.2: The Personal Energy Audit

Your core rep this week, about 15 minutes.

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LESSON 5 · ABOUT 55 MINUTES OF REPS THIS WEEK

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills

Lead self first, then lead others. Your core rep is your own energy, because your team copies what you do.

Drill 5.2

CORE REP · START HERE

The Personal Energy Audit

Wellbeing · lead self

15 min

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Drill 5.3

EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME

Modeling Sustainable Practices

Wellbeing · lead others

10 min

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Drill 5.4

EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME

The Team Recovery Protocol

Alignment · lead others

30 min

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Fill it in on screen. Type straight into the grey boxes and tick the boxes that apply. Save the file to keep your answers.

Or on paper. Print the pages and write by hand.

Then get feedback. Complete your core rep, then ask one person how it landed.

Drill 5.2 | Core rep · start here | About 15 minutes · Goes with Video 5.2

LEAD SELF: The Personal Energy Audit

The most effective leaders are masters of energy management. Time is finite, but energy is renewable if managed correctly. This drill helps you gather data on your personal energy drains and fuel sources so you can optimize your performance.

For one full workday this week, use the log below to track your energy. At several points during the day, note the activity you were just doing and how it made you feel.

My Daily Energy Audit Log

Activity / Meeting / Task	Time of Day	Energy level after (mark one)		
e.g., Team Budget Review Meeting	*e.g., 10 a.m.*	Drained	Neutral	Energized
		○	○	○
		○	○	○
		○	○	○
		○	○	○
		○	○	○
		○	○	○

Analysis and Action Plan

1. My Biggest Energy Giver Was

What single activity had the most positive impact on your energy?

2. My Biggest Energy Drainer Was

What single activity had the most negative impact on your energy?

3. One Change I Will Make

Based on this audit, what is one specific change you can make to your schedule or workflow next week to minimize a drain or maximize a giver?

The block I'll protect next week (day, time): _____

Drill 5.3 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 10 minutes · Goes with Video 5.3

LEAD OTHERS: Modeling Sustainable Practices

Your habits create your team's norms. The phrase "do as I say, not as I do" is the quickest way to lose credibility as a leader. Your play is to consciously model one behavior that sends a powerful signal to your team that Wellbeing is a non-negotiable part of high performance.

Choose one of the following plays to run consistently this week. Check the box to commit to it.

- ☐ **The "Schedule Send" Play** Use the "schedule send" feature for all emails written after 6 p.m., ensuring they arrive during business hours the next day.
- ☐ **The Full Break** Take a full lunch break, completely away from your desk and email, and encourage your team to do the same.
- ☐ **The Disconnect Praise** Explicitly praise a team member for taking their vacation time and fully disconnecting, reinforcing that rest is valued.
- ☐ **The Gift of Time** Proactively end a meeting you are leading 5-10 minutes early, explicitly giving everyone back time to transition.



✎ The sentence you'll use to introduce it to your team:

✎ Reflection: Why is modeling one of these behaviors more powerful than simply telling your team to "take care of their wellbeing"?

Drill 5.4 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 30 minutes · Goes with Video 5.4

LEAD OTHERS: The Team Recovery Protocol

In sports, recovery isn't optional; it's a strategic part of the training cycle. The same is true for elite teams in business. Your play is to proactively plan for your team's recovery before they hit the wall after their next big push.

Complete the Team Recovery Protocol Planner below, and then schedule the recovery event on the team calendar now. This makes it real.

Step 1

Identify the Next Big Push

What is the next major deadline, project launch, or intense period for your team?

Project / Deadline: _____ Target Date: _____

Step 2

Schedule a Recovery Protocol

What is one small but meaningful thing you can do as a team within a few days of that date to acknowledge the effort and facilitate recovery?

My Team's Recovery Protocol

Example

A celebratory team lunch, a "no-meetings" afternoon, a retrospective focused only on lessons learned and celebrating wins, a half day for professional development.

In the video, the order is: celebrate the wins, capture the lessons, give something back. Then plan.

Wins to celebrate: _____

Lessons to capture: _____

What we'll give back: _____

- [ ] It's on the team calendar.

Locker Room Reflection

Challenge: What is one “unwritten rule” or implicit expectation on your team that might be contributing to a culture of burnout (e.g., everyone stays online late, instant Teams/Slack responses are expected, lunch is eaten at the desk)? What is one specific step you can take as the leader to begin to change it?

This reflection goes with the real-world challenge from Video 5.4.



“Recovery isn’t a pause from performance. It’s the rhythm that makes sustained performance possible.”

My notes:

Get Feedback

Complete your core rep, then ask one person how it landed.

Who I asked: _____

What they said, and what I'll keep doing:

Back in the course: your Athleader Pro Huddle with Ryall Graber, then your Pulse Check.